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(1) Research Program/Project/Study Title: Predictors of University Students' Information-Seeking Behavior in a Post-Pandemic Environment	
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Program or Project has component (if no proceed to 2)? ☐ Yes ☒ No

Component Title:	
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(2) Category (please check) ☒ Social Science/Education /Humanities & other related fields ☐ Natural/BiologicalSciences ☐ Food Research/ ☐ Developmental/ Computer/Engineering/ Architecture ☐ Extension ☐ Poster		(3) Research Center [Check the concerned center] ☒ SSITRDC Social Science and Industrial Technology Research Development Center ☐ LRDC Livestock Research Development Center ☐ FFRDC Fisheries and Food Research Development Center ☐ CSRDC Crop Science Research Development Center						
(4) Site of implementation CAPSU <table border="1" style="width: 100%;"> <tr> <td>Municipality/City:</td> <td>Pontevedra</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Province:</td> <td>Capiz</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Region:</td> <td>VI</td> </tr> </table>			Municipality/City:	Pontevedra	Province:	Capiz	Region:	VI
Municipality/City:	Pontevedra							
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Region:	VI							
(5) Classification <table border="1" style="width: 100%;"> <tr> <td>Research:</td> <td>Development:</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☒ Basic</td> <td>☐ Pilot Testing</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☐ Applied</td> <td>☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization</td> </tr> </table>	Research:	Development:	☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing	☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization	(6) Mode of Implementation ☒ Single Authorship/Proponent ☐ Collaborative Research (within campus) ☐ Collaborative Research (intercampus) ☐ Collaborative Research (external agency)	
Research:	Development:							
☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing							
☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization							
(7) Sector/Commodity Higher Education Institution	(8) Discipline/Field of Specialization Development Communication/ English							
(9) Rationale Understanding the information-seeking behavior of university students is crucial for developing and implementing effective educational support systems. It is considered a purposive acquisition of information from selected information carriers. As students navigate the complexities of higher education, their diverse academic pursuits, research requirements, and personal interests create a spectrum of information needs. Institutions can strategically allocate resources to bolster students' information literacy skills by comprehending these needs. The rationale for studying information-seeking behavior is its direct correlation to academic success. Tailoring library resources, workshops, and digital platforms to meet specific information needs ensures								

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that students can access and evaluate information efficiently, fostering a culture of academic excellence. Sensitization should be the primary method for ensuring that students are well-equipped and educated about the information resources and services available in university libraries (Humbhi et al., 2022). Moreover, identifying common patterns and variations in information-seeking behavior enables institutions to stay responsive to evolving technological trends, ensuring that students' preferences and habits are considered in the design of educational resources. When an investigator or information-seeker realizes their current knowledge is insufficient for making decisions or conducting research, they engage in information-seeking behavior (Kumar, 2013).

Additionally, a nuanced understanding of information needs and utilization aids in addressing challenges unique to the context of Philippine universities. The need for information arises when the researcher feels something is missing, and they try to fill that research gap (Loneet et al., 2017; Mellon, 2015). The educational structure, technological landscape, and cultural nuances influence students' information-seeking approaches. The information needs of the information seekers are like variables that change over time (Uwa & Ossai-Onah, 2013). By acknowledging and adapting to these contextual intricacies, universities can bridge information gaps, enhancing the overall learning experience for students.

Investigating the information-seeking behavior of university students is a strategic investment in academic success and institutional adaptability. This knowledge empowers universities to tailor their support systems effectively, creating an environment where students can thrive intellectually and academically. There is a knowledge gap in a university within the Philippine context, which may further address the digital divide, digital competence, and information literacy skills, among others. For this reason, the researcher will explore the factors that predict the information-seeking behavior of university students in a Philippine higher education institution.

(9-A) Project Description

The proposed study will collaborate with the Social Science and Industrial Technology Research and Development Center. It will explore the information-seeking behavior of university students. This study will serve as a benchmark in addressing gaps in information and communication studies and technological infrastructures to strengthen further the instruction mandate of a higher education institution to be at par with international standards.

(10) Statement of the Problem

Generally, this study will determine university students' information-seeking behavior in a post-pandemic context.

Specifically, this study will seek answers to these questions:

1. What is the demographic profile of the university students in terms of the following: a) age, b) sex, c) course, d) year level, e) campus, f) reading preference, and format preference for reading?
2. What is the information-seeking behavior of pre-service students?
3. What is the frequency of using different search strategies for information search and retrieval of university students ?

3. What variables predict the information-seeking behavior of university students?

(11) Review of Literature

Information-Seeking Behavior

The Scholars believe that information needs are not homogeneous for everyone. They differ from person to person. According to Kalbande (2019), information is a cornerstone of modern civilization on which practically everyone relies. Everyone uses that information according to their needs (Silva & Chandrawamsa, 2016). Manjunath and Babu (2018) expressed that the progress of any nation will only be possible once and when the information is made available to people who need it.

A particular task or purpose guided the information-seeking behavior of library student-users, including conducting research. This was followed by preparing class reports and reading/thinking. Other

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purposes include reviewing for an examination, social networking, out of curiosity, entertainment, and leisure (Ingua, 2016). Students have information needs that are related to their academic activities. These are coursework, assignments, preparation for exams and tests, general reading, seminars, tutorial presentations, and group discussions (Oyadeyi, 2014). A study by Yunjie Xu et al. (2014) investigated and compared task and social information-seeking antecedents.

Information-Seeking Behavior and the Demographics

Gender is a cultural and social construct of personality, as manifested in the qualities and behaviors of men and women (Halder et al., 2013). The demographic profile is significantly associated with information-seeking and utilization behavior and other variables of student library users (Ingua, 2016). Further, Ingua (2016) found out that as to demographic profile and information seeking, older library student-users' purpose of information seeking is to conduct research work, prepare class notes, and prepare class reports. Females report more than males. Undergraduate library student users declared that information seeking is used to organize class notes and class reports. For the year level, all purposes are mentioned except for preparing class reports and state-of-the-art investigations. Higher year levels tend to declare research work as the purpose for information seeking compared to lower levels. However, lower-year levels are more likely to display general awareness, prepare answers to questions, read and think, and prepare class notes, observations, experiments, and discussions.

(12) Scientific Basis/Theoretical Framework

The study will be guided by the cybernetic theory of communication by which information-seeking follows a particular process or system, which is anchored to two models by Kuhltau (1991, 2007) and Wilson (1996).

Kuhltau's Information Search Process Model. Kuhltau's (1991, 2007) information search process (ISP) model has been identified as a theoretical basis for exploring information-seeking attitudes and behaviors, while the social learning and literacy concepts of Vygotsky (1962, 1978), Bruner (1962, 1964) and Jenkins (2010) have been identified as foundations of information sharing. The model of ISP describes users' experience in information-seeking as a series of thoughts, feelings, and actions. Thoughts that begin as uncertain, vague, and ambiguous become clearer, more focused, and specific as the search process progresses. Feelings of anxiety and doubt become more confident. Through their actions, people seek information relevant to the general topic in the beginning stages of the search process and pertinent to the focused topic toward closure. Formulating a focus or a personal perspective of the topic is a pivotal point in the search process. At that point, feelings shift from uncertain to confident, thoughts change from vague to more precise, and interest increases. The model was verified in longitudinal case studies and large-scale studies of diverse samples of library users. Further studies have examined implementing a process approach in education contexts and investigated the ISP in the workplace. The ISP describes common experiences in the information-seeking process for a complex task with a discrete beginning and ending that requires considerable construction and learning to be accomplished. The model reveals a search process in which a person seeks meaning while seeking information. From the user's perspective, the primary objective of information-seeking is to accomplish the task that initiated the search, not merely collecting information as an end. The ISP presents seeking information as a means to accomplish a goal. The model of the ISP is articulated in a holistic view of information-seeking from the user's perspective in six stages:

- *Initiation* is when a person first becomes aware of a lack of knowledge or understanding, and feelings of uncertainty and apprehension are common.
- *Selection* is when a general area, topic, or problem is identified, and initial uncertainty often gives way to a brief sense of optimism and a readiness to begin the search.
- *Exploration*, when inconsistent, incompatible information is encountered, and uncertainty, confusion, and doubt frequently increase, people find themselves "in the dip" of confidence.
- *Formulation* is when a focused perspective is formed, and uncertainty diminishes as confidence begins to increase.
- *The collection* is when information pertinent to the focused perspective is gathered, and uncertainty subsides as interest and involvement deepen.

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- *Presentation*, when the search is completed with a new understanding,, enabling the person to explain their learning to others or in some way put the knowledge to use.

Wilson's 1996 model on information behavior. Wilson's 1996 model is a major revision of 1981, drawing upon research from various fields other than information science, including decision-making, psychology, innovation, health communication, and consumer research.

The basic framework of the 1981 model persists in that the person in context remains the focus of information needs, the barriers are represented by 'intervening variables', and 'information-seeking' behavior' is identified. However, there are also changes: the use of the term 'intervening variables' serves to suggest that their impact may be supportive of information use as well as preventive; information-seeking behavior is shown to consist of more types than previously, where the 'active search' was the focus of attention; 'information processing and use' is shown to be a necessary part of the feedback loop, if information needs are to be satisfied; and three relevant theoretical ideas are presented: stress/coping theory, which offers possibilities to explaining why some needs do not invoke information-seeking behavior; risk/reward theory, which may help to explain which sources of information may be used more than others by a given individual; and social learning theory which embodies the concept of 'self-efficacy', the idea of 'the conviction that one can successfully execute the behavior required to produce the [desired] outcomes'.

Thus, the model remains one of macro-behavior, but its expansion and the inclusion of other theoretical models of behavior make it a richer source of hypotheses and further research than Wilson's earlier model.

(13) Methodology

The study will be using the descriptive-correlational research design. The study participants will be randomly selected college and graduate students of a Philippine state university. Stratified random sampling will be employed across all campuses' academic programs and year levels. The G Power will be used in computing and determining the sample size.

The information-seeking behavior instrument of Walia and Khatri (2023) will be used to gather data on the information-seeking behavior the information-seeking behavior and frequency of using different search strategies for information search and retrieval of the respondents. Data on demographic profile will be a researcher-made instrument which will be subjected for validity and reliability tests. Pilot testing will likewise be done. The questionnaire will be administered using Google Forms.

Permission from concerned authorities will be sought before conducting the study. Frequency, percentages, means, standard deviation and multiple regression will be used in analyzing the data through Social Packages for Social Sciences (SPSS).

(14) Major Activities/Work plan (Enumerate the tasks to be undertaken chronologically. Use the Gantt chart.

(See next page)

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Work Plan

Research Activities	Ma r	Ap r	Ma y	Ju n	Ju l	Au g	Se p	Oc t	No v	De c	Ja n	Ju n
1. Gathering and reading materials connected to the study of interest												
2. Writing of Proposal/Instrument Development												
3. Data Collection												
4. Analysis of data												
5. Writing research report												
6. Report presentation/dissemination												
7. Publication												

(15) Expected Output (Indicate the specific products, processes or services which the project is expected to produce; quantify when possible)
Publishable journal article

(15) Technology Transfer Activity Design (Indicate the specific products, activity design, processes or services to be transferred as extension activities)

(16) Target Beneficiaries (Who the clientele are and what are the expected outcome/effects of the use of the projects output)
The study is expected to have significant influences on the way faculty members, information specialists/librarians, instructional materials committees, curriculum planners, and administrators develop educational and information systems best to serve the needs of the academic and scientific communities.

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It will challenge the above-mentioned vital players to make a more significant effort to understand university students' new concepts of information-seeking patterns and the differing information channels and sources they employ, and to tailor the learning and information systems and services to best support such information-seeking behaviors.

It may mean changes in current university academic or instructional policies. This research will also serve as baseline data for the university's long-term plan on aspects of classroom communication and and information science infrastructure, particularly on whether or not the university can meet the projected information-seeking and utilization demands.

The findings of this study may serve as a guide for other future researchers in coming up with a tool that will aid them in dealing and coping with ideas on the online learning processes and how it is perceived by people involved.

(17) Personnel Requirement

Name	Role Program, Project, Study Leader)	Field of Specialization
CAPSU Team		
1. Dr. Louis Placido F. Lachica	Study Leader	DevCom/English

Percent time devoted to the Program/ Project/ Study

Program/Project Leader (in hours):

Program/Project Members (in hours):

SOURCES OF EXPENSES	Quantity	Amount (Php)
A. Fieldwork/Data Collection		
- Survey Expenses		Php 15,000.00
B. Documentation, photocopy, and printing expenses		5,000.00
C. Conference presentation expenses		15,000.00
D. Publication Expenses		50,000.00
TOTAL		85,000.00

(19) Literature Cited (include only those references published in reputable journals, and at least that from CAPSU Research Journal, <http://researchjournal.capsu.edu.ph/>)

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(20) Capsule Curriculum Vitae (One-page brief C.V. only)

LOUIS PLACIDO F. LACHICA

I. Personal Information

Date of Birth: February 19, 1984
 Place of Birth: Bailan, Pontevedra, Capiz
 Civil Status: Married
 Address: Baila, Pontevedra, Capiz
 Academic Rank: Asso. Prof. V
 Specialization: English
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II. Educational Background

Doctoral Degree:	Ph. D.	Major: DevCom
School:	UP Los Baños	
Master's Degree:	MA	Major: English
School:	Capiz State University Pontevedra Capiz	
Bachelor's Degree:	BSED	Major: English
School:	WVSU	

III. Designations/ Current Position: Director- Social Science and Industrial
 Technology Research and Development Center
 CAPSU